

major influence on her career.



VILLA MEDICI, ROME

As a winner of the Prix de Rome, Lili was invited to spend five years composing at this magnificent 16th-century villa. Ill health and the outbreak of war cut short her tenure, but it was here that she wrote her popular *Cortège* for flute and piano.

Overcoming hardship

Lili's short life was marked by robust musical genius as well as physical frailty. At the age of two—by which time she could sing melodies by ear—she fell gravely ill with Crohn's disease, which triggered pain and sickness in her life. However, Lili was precocious in her musical talents: she sang and also learned the piano, violin, cello, harp, and organ. Her studies were steered by Nadia, Fauré and, at the Conservatoire National de Paris, other leading musicians, including the composer Georges Caussade and the harpist Alphonse Hasselmans.